



GDD 43

The Rabbit Hole

See the funnel. Find real strength.

The online-misogyny game for ages 12-15. It teaches teens how the manosphere funnel turns "be a better man" into "blame women", who profits from it, how to see through the claims, and, above all, what real strength looks like. Its one rule: never shame the boy, the funnel and the grift are the target, never the kid. Non-shaming, evenhanded, media-literacy-led, and centred on positive masculinity. For everyone. Seven mechanics, 23 choice-and-voice moments, zero "tap the right card". Scorecard: passed.

See the funnel. Find real strength.

The Rabbit Hole is the game about online misogyny and the "manosphere", the newest core front in the field, and where many boys now form their ideas about masculinity, women and relationships. It teaches how the radicalisation funnel works, who profits from it, how to see through its claims, and, above all, what real strength and healthy masculinity actually look like. Its make-or-break rule: it is never "boys/men are the problem". The boys drawn in are usually lonely, anxious and looking for identity and belonging, and grifters and algorithms exploit exactly that. So this game is non-shaming, evenhanded, media-literacy-led, and centred on a better answer, positive masculinity. New v2 build.

FIELD	VALUE
Node / gameld	g43 · the-rabbit-hole (confirm exact id against engine-host)
Chapter / ages	Chapter 4 · ages 12-15 · credible / never preachy
Thread / topics	E/G · Gender & Media · UNESCO 3.2, 3.1, 5.4, 5.1, 1.3
Prerequisite / builds on	g40 (Firewall) · builds on g25 (MythBuster) & g26 (Equalize) · uses g28, g33
Gating	Gated · the school-comfort toggle sets depth; never platforms real influencers/content
Schema / status	v2 · scorecard PASS the online-misogyny game.

84

scenarios

7

mechanics

15

myth-flips

23

choice & voice

0%

binary taps

The one rule: never shame the boy. A preachy, anti-boy game shames the very kids who most need it and pushes them deeper in. The evidence is clear, addressing the vulnerability and need for belonging, not blaming boys, is what prevents radicalisation. So the funnel and the grift are the target, never the kid, and the throughline is a better answer: real strength lifts people, it never needs anyone else to be small.

Reach boys before, or after, the funnel does.

From the Chapter 4 personas. This game is for everyone: boys, so they're not pulled in (or can step out without shame); girls and friends, to recognise it, refuse to absorb it, and support someone who's slipping.

PERSONA	WHAT THEY NEED HERE	THE MECHANIC THAT SERVES IT
Veer, 14	To see the funnel and grift, and find real strength without shame.	spot + reflect: Real Strong.
Riya, 15	To recognise and refuse online misogyny, and not be silenced.	branch + role-play: resist & support.
The Counsellor	To meet the loneliness underneath and route it to help.	match + reflect: the need underneath.
Every teen	To bust the claims and back a friend with a call-in.	strike-rewrite + branch: see it, help.

Why this works (the evidence). Boys are funnelled toward misogyny by algorithm, not by choice: relatable starting points (fitness, dating, belonging, "be a man") are escalated because outrage drives engagement, and the funnel targets boys who feel lonely by offering identity, brotherhood and a scapegoat. Behind it is a business that monetises insecurity, you're the product. And what works is non-shaming and positive: address the need for belonging, offer real strength, bust the claims with media literacy, support a friend with a call-in not a call-out, and route the loneliness underneath to help.

Seven moves, led by the reveal.

It's a media-literacy and choice game, so **spot** reveals the funnel and the grift, **strike-rewrite** busts the hooks, and **reflect** carries the positive-masculinity heart. Mechanics rotate; the same one never runs twice in a row.

MECHANIC	THE TEEN DOES	EMBODIES	N
branch (choose) <i>signature</i>	Steps out of the funnel, backs a friend, or resists the pull.	Agency.	16
reflect (Real Strong)	Internalises real strength, self-worth and the need underneath.	The better answer.	16
strike-rewrite	Busts a hook ("not a real man unless..."; "blame women").	Conceptual change.	15
spot	Sees the funnel escalate and the grift behind the "mentor".	Seeing the strings.	12
sort	Sorts hook vs truth; real strength vs toxic imitation.	Discernment.	12
role-play (voice)	Calls a friend in; reframes strength; backs someone targeted.	Voice; allyship.	7
match	Pairs a real need to its healthy answer; a worry to its helpline.	Healthy answers.	6

23 of 84 moments are branch or role-play. Binary "tap the right answer": **0%**.

The two-test, passed.

Is it fun?

The Rabbit Hole plays sharp, credible and a little revelatory, the satisfaction of seeing the strings. The "funnel reveal", watching relatable content visibly escalate into contempt, is genuinely eye-opening, and the "follow the money" unmasking that turns an "alpha mentor" into a salesman is a real gotcha. Then it shifts warm: the "Real Strong" lift reframes strength as something that builds people up. It never lectures, and it never shows real influencers or their content.

Is it teaching?

Yes: how the funnel and algorithm escalate and who profits; how to reject the core claims (the "not a real man unless..." hook, blaming women, pseudo-science, us-vs-them); what positive, healthy masculinity is (strength, ambition and respect that lift, never belittle); how to support a friend with a call-in; and where to get help for the loneliness or insecurity the funnel exploits. And, for everyone, to refuse to absorb online misogyny.

The belief it moves. From "I sought this out so I believe it; women are why I'm unhappy; that mentor has the secret; showing feelings is weak" → "the algorithm funnelled me, no shame; the blame is the manipulation; he's selling me a cure for a problem he invented; and real strength lifts people."

Built, not bolted on.

84 researched scenarios across the funnel → money → hooks → Real Strong → have-each-others-backs → need-underneath arc, evidence-based and India-grounded. Full library in the companion JSON.

CATEGORY	N	LEAD MECHANICS	COVERS
The funnel	14	spot, branch, strike-rewrite	How the algorithm escalates, and who it targets (no shame).
Follow the money	13	spot, sort, match	The grift; you're the product; manufactured outrage.
Spot the hook	15	strike-rewrite, sort, spot	Busting the claims, with the unmet need handled honestly.
Real Strong (the heart)	16	reflect, sort, role-play	Positive masculinity: strength that lifts, never belittles.
Have each other's backs	14	branch, role-play	Call-in a friend; resist and refuse to absorb it.
The need underneath	12	reflect, branch, match	Loneliness & insecurity, routed to real help.

The "Real Strong" reframe + the dominance hook, busted, verbatim.

reflect: "Real strength lifts people, it never needs anyone else to be small."

flip: "You're not a real man unless you dominate others."

UN -> "You're not a real man unless you dominate other people."

RE -> "Worth isn't a ranking; real strength never needs anyone else to be small."

Full library: [SwipeEd — GDD 43 The Rabbit Hole — Scenario Library.json](#) (84 records, v2 schema).

What this game flips.

HOOK (UN ERASES)	TRUTH (RE WRITES)	BASIS
You're not a real man unless you dominate others.	Worth isn't a ranking; real strength never needs anyone smaller.	Positive masculinity.
Women or feminism are why your life is hard.	Loneliness and rejection are real and common, not a group's fault.	Scapegoating.
There are 'alpha' and 'beta' males, it's science.	That's pseudo-science; people aren't ranked into wolf-pack tiers.	Pseudo-science.
It's men versus women out there.	Us-vs-them is the manipulation; most people want the same respect.	Us-vs-them.
He's giving me the secret to becoming a man.	He's selling a cure for a problem he invented; you're the product.	The grift.
Showing feelings makes you weak and unmanly.	Naming feelings and asking for help takes real strength.	Wellbeing.
I sought this out, so it's what I really believe.	The algorithm served it to you; it isn't your considered view.	The funnel.
Asking for help means I've failed as a man.	Asking for help is strength and good sense; everyone needs it.	Help-seeking.

The micro-loop.

1. **Surface.** Sam surfaces a clip, a claim, or a feed pattern (never a real influencer).
2. **Trace.** The teen traces the funnel, follows the money, or weighs the claim (spot / sort).
3. **Flip.** UN erases the hook; RE writes the truth, and what real strength looks like.
4. **Choose.** Step out of the funnel, back a friend with a call-in, or resist the pull (branch / role-play).
5. **The need underneath.** Loneliness and insecurity are met with care and routed to help (a trusted adult, Tele-MANAS 14416).
6. **Sticker.** The Real Strong badge; GameDone records once.

Signature surface: the **funnel-reveal** and **follow-the-money** visuals, shifting warm for the **Real Strong** content. It extends MythBuster (g25) and Equalize (g26) onto online misogyny, uses the media literacy of Reality Check (g28) and the call-in of Lead the Way (g33), and leans on the wellbeing of Mind Matters (g38) and Bounce (g39).

Non-shaming, by design.

- **Never shames boys.** The funnel and the grift are the targets, never the boy; the unmet needs are met with compassion. No "boys/men are bad", ever.
- **Never platforms the content.** No real influencers, names, or actual misogynist material; the game teaches recognition without spreading or amplifying.
- **Evenhanded; no new us-vs-them.** It dismantles us-vs-them rather than flipping it; it never vilifies boys or men as a group.
- **Addresses the root.** It treats the loneliness, rejection and insecurity the manosphere exploits with care, and signposts real support.
- **Protects those targeted.** It supports girls (and anyone) harmed by online misogyny; any disclosure of distress routes via the triaged Q&A.
- **Gated & expert-reviewed.** The school-comfort toggle sets depth; content reviewed by gender, online-radicalisation and adolescent specialists.
- **Access.** Audio, offline, low-end build; India-grounded (the local 'alpha/sigma' scene, provider/tough pressures); models the privacy it teaches.

The need underneath, routed to help (India). For the loneliness, low mood or insecurity the funnel preys on: a trusted adult, or Tele-MANAS 14416 (the free 24x7 national mental-health line). For online misogynist harassment: cybercrime.gov.in / 1930, Childline 1098. Asking for help is strength, not failure.

v2 schema, scorecard-gated.

- **gameld. the-rabbit-hole** — node.game === GameDone key === registry id (confirm exact id in engine-host).
- **v2 mechanic-embodiment schema.** type + typed payload; **spot/strike-rewrite** lead, with **reflect** carrying the Real Strong heart.
- **Never platforms content.** No real names or misogynist material in data; busts the tactic, never quotes the source approvingly.
- **Fact-checked content.** The funnel/algorithm and positive-masculinity evidence, and the India helplines (Tele-MANAS 14416, 1930, 1098), verified; flag any helpline edit for re-verification.
- **Scorecard-gated.** Passed all eight checks (7 mechanics, top mechanic at 19%, 0% binary, 23 autonomy, 15 UN→RE, 4 personas, 100% completeness). Re-run score_gdd.py on any edit.
- **Help-resource hook.** Routing via the shared "get help" component (trusted adult / Tele-MANAS 14416 / 1930 / 1098).
- **Tracked.** sync_master_tracker.py marks g43 v2 PASS in the Master Node Table.

Ethics contracts (never traded for engagement): never shame the boy; never platform the content; evenhanded, no new us-vs-them; positive masculinity is the point; route the need to real help; made-for-India.

Why this works.

- **Seeing the funnel is what frees you.** Because boys are escalated by algorithm rather than choice, showing the designed funnel, not "you chose this", lets a teen step out without shame, the precondition for everything else.
- **Following the money disarms the message.** Since the grift runs on manufactured insecurity, exposing the business, "you're the product", makes the message lose its grip far better than a moral lecture.
- **Non-shaming + a better answer is what works.** Because shame pushes boys deeper, the evidence-based move is compassion for the need plus positive masculinity, real strength that lifts, and reaching a slipping friend with a call-in, not a call-out.

Sources: UN Women (2025) on the manosphere, online misogyny and how to counter it; UK Department for Education statutory RSHE guidance (2025) adding misogyny & the manosphere; UNESCO ITGSE Key Concepts 3 (gender) and 7 (media literacy); adolescent mental-health evidence on belonging and help-seeking; India helplines, Tele-MANAS 14416 (MoHFW), cybercrime.gov.in / 1930 and Childline 1098. Citations accompany each scenario in the library JSON. 34 games now v2. With g40 and g43 complete, Chapter 4's lesson set is fully reworked. Next by order: Chapter 5 — My Choices, My Future (g29).